WEIGHT 16

Tesofensine

Small molecule taken by mouth that blocks reuptake of noradrenaline, dopamine and serotonin



CLASS Small molecule

STUDIED FOR Weight, hypothalamic obesity

HUMAN EVIDENCE Controlled human trials (Phase 2)

US STATUS Not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

Body weight	Hypothalamic obesity	Appetite
HUMAN + ANIMAL	HUMAN	ANIMAL

No Phase 3 trial published. In 2013 The Lancet published an expression of concern about the 2008 Phase 2 trial paper.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Tesofensine → Reuptake block → NE, dopamine, 5-HT → Food intake

- **Triple reuptake inhibitor:** noradrenaline, dopamine and serotonin
- **First tested** for Parkinson's and Alzheimer's; weight loss led to obesity trials
- **In obese rats,** lowered food intake and changed dopamine in reward areas
- **In people,** the mechanism of weight loss is not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CONTROLLED TRIALS
LEVEL 4 OF 5

- Phase 2: 203 adults, 24 weeks (Denmark)
- Tesomet trial: 21 adults, 24 weeks
- No published Phase 3 trial

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Side-effect profile
- Drug interactions

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE Not established in people	**ROUTES STUDIED** By mouth, daily (trials)
PHARMACOKINETICS Limited human data	**SOLD AS** Not approved in the US
MONITORED IN TRIALS Weight, heart rate, blood pressure	**SPORT (WADA)** Prohibited in competition, class S6

REGULATORY FDA: Not approved · EMA: Not authorised · WADA: Prohibited in competition (S6.B)

REFERENCES

1. Astrup et al., tesofensine Phase 2, Lancet, Nov 2008
2. Huynh et al., Tesomet in hypothalamic obesity, Eur J Endocrinol, May 2022
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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